came to be based, or was showcased as being based, on welfare measures, specifically medical care and the nurture of living beings in distant realms, both human and animal. Two kinds of medical facility were established: hospitals, and facilities in which roots, fruit, and medicinal plants hitherto unavailable were imported and planted. Roads were laid and wells dug for 'enjoyment' by animals and humans. The compassionate and moral life now also becomes Mauryan foreign policy.

The monarch's immediate personal access to officials at all times is another policy carefully proclaimed:

> Formerly, in the ages gone by, there was no transaction of state-business and no reporting (of incidents to the king) at all hours.
>
> So I have made the following (arrangement).
>
> The reporters should report to me the affairs of the people at any time and place, whether I am engaged in eating (or) am in the harem (or) in the bed-chamber (or) on a promenade (or) in a carriage (or) on the march.
>
> And I am now attending to the people's affairs at all places.
>
> And, when I issue an order orally in connection with any donation or proclamation or when an emergent work presses itself upon the Mahamatras (and) in case there is, in connection with that matter, a controversy among (the Ministers of) the Council or an argumentation (in the Council in favour of a particular view), the fact must be reported to me immediately at any place and at any time.
>
> Thus have I ordered.[13]

The *Arthashastra* had stressed the importance of such accessibility too. The king was expected to be always active, hear urgent matters and never put them off, look into the affairs of all kinds of people and places: 'temple deities, hermitages, heretics, Brahmins learned in the Vedas, cattle and holy places, of minors, of the aged, the sick, the distressed and the helpless and of women, in this order, or, in accordance with the importance of the matter or its urgency.'[14] The manual prescribes designated areas for the king's public interactions. Unrestricted entrance was necessary for those wanting